

Storyline review guide

A disciplined review for clear narratives that enable an executive decision.

AUDIENCE	Authors, reviewers and presentation leads
PURPOSE	Improve the logic, evidence and actionability of client-facing narratives.
VERSION	1.0 As of 13 Jul 2026
OWNER	Nina Solberg Quality Assurance

The storyline test

A strong storyline starts with the decision, makes one central point, groups supporting evidence logically, names uncertainty, and ends with a clear action. Slides are evidence containers, not a transcript of team discussion.

Review questions

- Can a sponsor restate the requested decision in one sentence?
- Does each page have a conclusion-led title?
- Are causal claims proportionate to the evidence?
- Do exhibits use consistent units, periods and definitions?
- Is the next step owned and time-bound?

Control record: minimum evidence for a review

Control point	Evidence to retain	Decision rule
Scope	Decision statement and named audience	Proceed only when scope is bounded.
Evidence	Source/assumption log and review notes	Separate verified facts from estimates.
Action	Owner, timing and next review date	Assign one accountable owner.

Application notes

Worked example: Client Alpha

Synthetic example data. Weak title: “Finance workstream update.” Strong title: “Approve Phase 1 diagnostic mobilization within the JPY 42.8M approved budget while validating demand assumptions.” The latter states context and decision without inventing a result.

Pyramid and flow

Place the answer first, then three to five mutually distinct reasons, then proof. Use transitions that show why the next page follows. If two exhibits make the same point, retain the clearer one and move the other to backup.

Decision worksheet

Control point	Evidence to retain	Decision rule
Scope	Decision statement and named audience	Proceed only when scope is bounded.
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Action	Owner, timing and next review date	Assign one accountable owner.

Practice note. Use concise records that make the next decision easier. This guide is an internal operating reference; it is not a substitute for engagement-specific governance.

Execution and review

Review outcome

Mark each issue as must-fix, improve or editorial. Must-fix items affect decision quality, factual integrity or client trust. Capture the owner and re-review only the changed pages plus dependent pages.

Practical checklist

- Confirm the purpose and audience before working from the guide.
- Maintain clear distinction between verified facts, assumptions and synthetic examples.
- Record accountable owner, next step and decision date.
- Invite an independent reviewer when conclusions or access risks are material.
- Update the engagement record after the decision is made.

Sign-off prompts

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Summit Vale Advisory | Internal reference guide | As of 13 Jul 2026 | Owner: Avery Calder, Engagement Excellence